

# Sinus Pain or Congestion - Male (Child)

Algorithm 1263 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Male

## Definition

- Sinusitis assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Child patient.
- Male.

## Initial assessment

1. [DURATION] How long have symptoms lasted?
2. [OPEN\_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant/breastfeeding or immunocompromised, and what treatments or medicines have been tried?
3. [TEMPERATURE] Has a temperature been measured?
4. [CAREGIVER\_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

## Triage and redirect questions

### **1. Redirect → Nasal Allergies**

Are sneezing, itchy or watery eyes, and clear nasal discharge the main symptoms without facial pain, pressure, fever, or thick discharge?

Symptoms dominated by an allergic pattern belong in the Nasal Allergies pathway.

### **1. Disposition level 100**

Is there swelling/redness around an eye, eye displacement, double or reduced vision, painful/restricted eye movement, severe frontal headache, neck stiffness, confusion, seizure, focal weakness, reduced consciousness, or a rapidly deteriorating child or adult?

Orbital or intracranial complications and severe systemic illness are uncommon but time-critical and cannot be excluded remotely.

### **1. Disposition level 70**

Is the person very unwell, are painkillers not helping or symptoms getting worse, or does the caller have a weakened immune system?

NHS.UK sinusitis guidance recommends urgent clinical review or emergency medical assessment for these features.

### **1. Disposition level 50**

Has there been no improvement after 7 days of pharmacy or primary-care treatment or 3 weeks of self-treatment, does sinusitis keep recurring, or is the patient 11 or younger?

NHS.UK guidance recommends primary-care review for these situations.

### **1. Disposition level 15**

Is this a typical, recent case with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance: a pharmacist can provide the same treatments as a primary-care clinician for sinusitis.

## Advice

### **Qatar emergency sinus-complication response**

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive. Do not delay for another remote assessment or give leftover antibiotics. Keep the person with you; if consciousness or breathing worsens, follow 999 instructions and begin age-appropriate CPR if unresponsive and not breathing normally. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: eye swelling or visual change; severe headache, neck stiffness, confusion, seizure, or weakness; reduced consciousness or rapid deterioration.

### **Urgent sinusitis review**

- Arrange same-day in-person review through the Qatar route approved by governance, with a lower threshold for a young child, pregnancy, immunocompromise, severe pain, dehydration, or worsening illness. Do not use leftover antibiotics or another person's medicine.
- Call Back If: symptoms worsen; fever or eye symptoms develop.

### **Governed sinusitis follow-up**

- Arrange in-person review for persistent or recurring symptoms. Pediatric age limits, pregnancy-safe treatment, antibiotic criteria, and exact Qatar route require governance approval.
- Call Back If: symptoms worsen; new eye, neurological, or systemic symptom.

### **Governed supportive sinus care**

- Rest, avoid smoke and known triggers, and maintain usual fluids if not restricted. Saline products and pain/decongestant medicines require age, pregnancy/breastfeeding, allergy, heart/blood-pressure disease,

kidney/liver disease, and current-medicine checks under the approved Qatar pathway; do not advise homemade nasal solutions or antibiotics without approved instructions.

- Call Back If: not improving as expected; symptoms worsen; eye swelling, visual change, severe headache, confusion, or neck stiffness.

## First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive. Do not delay for another remote assessment or give leftover antibiotics. Keep the person with you; if consciousness or breathing worsens, follow 999 instructions and begin age-appropriate CPR if unresponsive and not breathing normally. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

## References

- NHS.UK, "Sinusitis (sinus infection)", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/sinusitis-sinus-infection/> (page last reviewed 31 January 2024)

## Provenance

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